



A Capital Bus vehicle on route 2. The route number belongs to the joint network; the livery and the fleet belong to the company.

捷利 [HTTPS://COMMONS.WIKIMEDIA.ORG/WIKI/FILE:CAPITAL_BUS_683-U5_HEAD_AT_EXIT_Y17,_TAIPEI_CITY_MALL_20230307.JPG] · CC BY-SA 4.0 [HTTPS://CREATIVECOMMONS.ORG/LICENSES/BY-SA/4.0] · WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

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The joint-operation network

Around 280 routes, fourteen private companies and one brand. Four city regulations set out how the money actually moves — and the central revenue pool everyone repeats is in none of them.

14 companies^[1]

OPERATING ONE NETWORK UNDER ONE BRAND

Around 280 routes and about 3,500 vehicles between them. To a passenger it looks like a single city bus system. It is not one, and it never has been.

THE JOINT-OPERATION NETWORK			
SYSTEM 聯營公車, joint operation [/bus/network/joint-operation/] ^[1]	ROUTES ~280 ^[1]	OPERATORS 14 ^[1]	VEHICLES ~3,500 ^[1]
JOINT OPERATION BEGAN 30 April 1977 ^[1]	PREPARATORY COMMITTEE 1976 ^[1]	REGULATOR Taipei [/rail/thsr/stations/taipei/] Public Transport Office ^[1]	DECISION BODY 臺北市公車聯營管理委員會 ^[5]
TRUNK-ROUTE COLOURS 綠 north–south, 藍 east–west, 黃 neither ^[3]	LOSS SUBSIDY SPLIT Central government ⅓, Taipei [/rail/thsr/stations/taipei/] City ⅔ ^[9]	CENTRAL REVENUE POOL Not established — see below	

To a passenger, Taipei [/rail/thsr/stations/taipei/] has one city bus network: one brand, one fare structure, one route numbering scheme, one app. **It is fourteen private companies**, and it has been a negotiated arrangement between them since 1977 ^[1].

The regulator's own summary is unglamorous and worth stating exactly: around **280 routes**, **14 operators**, about **3,500 vehicles** ^[1]. Nothing about that is visible from a bus stop, which is the point of the arrangement.

Where it came from

The city's buses began as a municipal monopoly. 臺北市公共汽車管理處 ran **51 routes with 651 vehicles** ^[1]. Private operation was opened up in part from 1969, when 欣欣, 大有, 大南 and 光華 joined in succession and the network grew to **90 routes and 847 vehicles** ^[1].

Joint operation proper began on **30 April 1977**, when five more private operators — 中興, 指南, 台北, 三重 [/rail/metro/stations/o15/] and 三重市公車, today's 首都客運 — came in ^[1]. The regulator's account: **149 routes were allocated**, 2,325 vehicles were planned for joint operation, and **1,984 actually ran** ^[1].

How many routes it started with — two official answers

The operators' own body describes the same year differently. It says the first phase opened with **33 routes**, and that three further phases during 1977 opened **50, 31 and 16** more ^[5] — **130** in all.

ROUTES AT THE START	SOURCE	KIND
149 , 「當時分配路線149條」	Public Transport Office ^[1]	Primary

33, then 50 + 31 + 16 across four 1977 phases

臺北市公車聯營管理委員會^[5]

Primary

One figure may count routes *allocated* on day one and the other routes *opened* across the year. **Neither source says so**, both are the bodies' own numbers, and this page publishes both rather than picking.

Afterwards

Through the late 1980s and 1990s many intercity routes run by the former 臺灣省公路局 were absorbed into joint operation, either renumbered outright or taken in as 區段聯營, joint operation over a section^[1]. The municipal operator itself stopped being municipal: on **1 January 2004** 臺北市公共汽車管理處 was corporatised and renamed 大都會汽車客運^[1].

A recent and easily missed change: some journeys on low-demand routes have been moved to a **booking system** rather than a timetable — 「針對部分路線班次搭乘需求低且不固定之班次納入預約制」^[1].

Who decides

The 臺北市公車聯營管理委員會 is formed by the participating operators themselves, with the Public Transport Office as the supervising authority, and it describes itself as the 「決策及業務執行單位」 — the body that both decides and executes^[5]. Its stated duties are narrower than the name suggests: maintaining and managing bus stop signs, public relations, liaison between passengers, regulator and operators, and **review of joint electronic-ticketing business**^[5].

Ten participants founded it: the municipal 臺北市公共汽車管理處, the four operators admitted from 1969 (欣欣客運, 大有巴士, 大南汽車, 光華巴士) and the five admitted in 1977 (中興巴士, 指南客運, 臺北客運, 三重客運 and 三重市公車, now 首都客運)^[5].

One body or two? zh.wikipedia describes a two-tier structure — the committee as the decision body and a separate 臺北市公車聯營管理中心 as the executive one^[2]. The committee's own page describes a single body doing both^[5]. Published as the disagreement it is.

A standing city committee sits above all this and reviews costs, fares and subsidies: seventeen members convened by the head of the Department of Transportation, with seats for the Ministry of Transportation and Communications, its Institute of Transportation, the Consumers' Foundation and — notably — the operators' own 臺北市公車聯營管理委員會, whose tasks include 「定期檢討聯營公車營運成本及票價事項」^[11]. **The version of that rule read here is marked repealed**; a successor exists and has not been read, so treat the structure as indicative rather than current.

How the money moves

The arrangement is usually described in one sentence about a central revenue pool. No opened primary source establishes that sentence. The city's own regulations instead set out a different and more specific machine, in four parts.

Routes are allocated, not owned

An operator does not own a route. The city allocates them, and it does so on **points**: when the Public Transport Office allocates a joint-operation route or reallocates a revoked one, **the operator with the most accumulated route points chooses first, and is docked ten points for doing so** — 「得由累計獲有路線積分分數最多之聯營公車業者優先選線 1 條，並扣除路線積分 10 分」^[8].

The alternative path is open tender: the city canvasses operators' interest and a review committee, the 臺北都會區市區及公路客運路線審議委員會, selects the operator^[8].

The city can also take a profitable route away. The rule carries a heading that says so outright — 「本處收回業者高營收路線接駛原則」, principles for recovering high-revenue routes from operators. The successor operator gets **five years**, must apply to continue one year before that expires, and can be extended by at most three more; it must run the original alignment and may not apply to adjust it for a year^[8].

That single provision does more to explain the shape of the network than any account of pooling: **a route that earns well is a thing the regulator can move between operators.**

Vehicle counts are constrained, not centrally set — and evaluation scores the operator, never the route

No general "buses per route" formula exists. The route-allocation regulation constrains vehicle counts only in two specific situations: when a route changes hands, the incoming operator's proposed vehicle count may not exceed what the route had before, 「接駛業者以維持原輸運能量及不得高於原有配車數下，提出該路線需配置車輛數」^[14]; and a designated 服務性路線 — a route an operator cannot refuse — is capped at 20% of that operator's own highest-revenue route's vehicle count, 「指定接駛之服務性路線配車數以接駛最高營收路線配車數之百分之 20（四捨五入）為上限」^[14]. Outside those two administrative cases, no source found sets vehicle counts by route length, frequency or ridership.

The operator service-rating scheme [\[/bus/network/operator-ratings/\]](/bus/network/operator-ratings/) scores the **operator**, never the individual route^[15]. The regulation says so directly: 「路線積分，係指交通局依各期評鑑成績及評鑑項目成績所給予之評分」 — route points are the score the Department of Transportation assigns from each period's *operator-level* evaluation, not a score computed for a route^[15]. Those points stay valid for two years^[15]. No published route-level service-quality metric exists on this site's evidence.

Where the fare-stage line actually falls

The 段次 [\[/ticketing/guides/bus-fare-stages/\]](/ticketing/guides/bus-fare-stages/) (fare-stage) boundary for a two-segment route is not published as a citywide map anywhere found — but it *is* published, per individual route, on the government's real-time bus system, ebus.gov.taipei [\[https://ebus.gov.taipei/\]](https://ebus.gov.taipei/)^[13]. Three examples, read directly:

ROUTE	FARE	BOUNDARY
信義幹線 (MRT Kunyang–Taipei Main Station)	一段票, single stage	none
260 (Yangmingshan–Taipei Main Station)	兩段票, two stages	岩山里—劍潭 ^[13]
0東 (Neihu–Taipei Main Station)	兩段票, two stages	outbound 新益里—忠孝敦化路口; return MRT 忠孝敦化站—新益里 ^[13]

0東's boundary is not the same pair reversed — the outbound and return boundaries sit at different stop pairs entirely^[13]. Whether that asymmetry is typical of two-segment routes generally, or particular to 0東, is not established from a two-route sample. No source found aggregates every route's boundary into one table or map; the general fare-stage rule itself is stated by the joint committee, 「臺北市 聯營公車係依路段分段收費，搭乘二段票(含)以上路線之車輛，若跨越分段點(或分段緩衝區)，應加收一段票」^[16].

Losses are subsidised route by route, on a published formula

Operating-loss subsidy is made under a *central* regulation, not a city one: 「特依交通部令頒大眾運輸事業補貼辦法訂定本作業規定」^[9]. An operator may apply where a route it still ran at the end of the previous December earned **less per bus-kilometre than its reasonable operating cost**^[9]. The formula is stated:

$$(\text{每車公里合理營運成本} - \text{每車公里實際營運收入}) \times (\text{車次數}) \times (\text{路線往返里程})$$

Reasonable operating cost per bus-kilometre, minus **actual** operating revenue per bus-kilometre, times the number of departures, times the round-trip route length^[9]. The units are defined next door: 里程 is single-direction kilometres and one 車次 is a round trip, two departures^[8].

Three further provisions worth having:

PROVISION	WHAT IT SAYS
Cost sharing	For routes up to 30 km and up to 30 車次 a day, central government one third, Taipei City two thirds ^[9]
Priority classes	Three tiers, and 捷運接駁 metro feeders are a named priority class in their own right ^[9]
The ceiling	An operator drawing more than NT\$10 million in approved subsidy across two years can have the route put out to open recruitment; new-route franchises run five years ^[9]

This is the load-bearing point on the whole money question. The subsidy is computed against 每車公里實際營運收入 — actual operating revenue per bus-kilometre, *on that route, for that operator*^[9]. Revenue is therefore attributed to individual routes and individual operators in the city's own regulation. Any account of a central pool has to be reconciled with that, and none of the accounts that assert a pool attempts to.

Concessionary fares are reimbursed monthly, per operator

Where a passenger pays a concessionary fare, the difference between that and the single tariff is budgeted and paid by government — 「票價與單一運價間之差額，由政府編列預算補貼之金額」，under 發展大眾運輸條例 第九條^[10]. The recipients are named as 「經營本市聯營公車路線之公車業者」, the operators, individually^[10].

The cycle is **monthly** — 「價差補貼款之審核核撥週期：每月1次」 — with operators filing by the twentieth of the following month, and the claims are audited against the **card issuers'** records via a route-by-route subsidy application, an operating detail return and a card-tap record. Payments are docked for abnormal taps, over-age vehicles, lapsed insurance, missing announcement equipment and wage non-compliance^[10].

The early split — a thread, not an answer

zh.wikipedia's article on Taipei bus tokens states that the early years of joint operation used a **四分法**, a fixed-formula division of revenue, and that this is why fare theft by one company hurt the other three: 「北市公車聯營初期是採用依固定公式分配收入的『四分法』，所以某家公司吃票嚴重，會影響其他三家公司利益」^[17].

Read that with its footnote showing. The footnote resolves to 唯真, 〈關心話題 正本清源談公車票證〉, 聯合報, 13 April 1981 — a newspaper article whose full body could not be fetched from the closed 聯合報 archive^[17]. It is also confined to the *early* period, and nothing found explains why a "four-way" split describes an arrangement that had ten participants. It is recorded here as the closest thing to a sourced revenue-distribution mechanism anywhere, and as a lead rather than a finding.

What a route number tells you

Enough that it is worth learning, and nothing in English explains it.

The coloured routes are metro feeders

紅, 綠, 藍, 棕 and 橘 in front of a route number are not decoration. They are metro line colours, and a bus carrying one is a 捷運接駁公車 — an MRT feeder, serving the areas a line does not reach and terminating at one of its stations^[2].

PREFIX ENGLISH FEEDS

紅	R	Tamsui-Xinyi Line	[/rail/metro/lines/tamsui-xinyi-line/]
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綠	G	Songshan–Xindian Line [/rail/metro/lines/songshan-xindian-line/]
藍	BL	Bannan Line [/rail/metro/lines/bannan-line/]
棕	BR	Wenhu Line [/rail/metro/lines/wenhu-line/]
橘	O	Zhonghe–Xinlu Line [/rail/metro/lines/zhonghe-xinlu-line/]

So 藍26 is a Bannan Line feeder and 棕10 is a Wenhu Line feeder^[2], and a visitor who knows the metro already knows roughly where either one goes. Feeder buses are one of the six service categories the Public Transport Office lists^[1].

One caveat travels with that table. The metro-line reading is zh.wikipedia's and the news reports' — the latter give only 「捷運接駁公車」 for a colour prefix without saying the colour names a line^[6]. Nothing found in this project's searches is a Public Transport Office publication stating that 紅/綠/藍/棕/橘 are metro line colours. The rule is almost certainly right; it is not, on this site's evidence, regulator-published.

The Taoyuan Airport MRT [\[/rail/metro/lines/airport-mrt/\]](/rail/metro/lines/airport-mrt/) **has no prefix**, and that is a real gap rather than an omission here: the line opened in 2017, is run by a different operator, and its feeder services were never folded into the colour scheme^[2].

The leading digit records fare and service, not geography

Two Taiwanese outlets ran the same explanation of the numbering and both attribute it to the same named official: 臺北市公共運輸處主任秘書楊欽文, Chief Secretary of the Public Transport Office^[6] ^[7]. These are news reports *about* what the regulator says, not the regulator — but they are the first material this site has found that puts the numbering rule in the regulator's own mouth.

TOKEN WHAT IT RECORDS^[6]

Up to 2 digits	一段票 — a single-segment fare
2xx	兩段票 — two fare segments
3xx	三段票 — three fare segments
5xx	冷氣公車, air-conditioned, one segment
6xx	冷氣公車, two segments — <i>disputed, see below</i>
7xx	冷氣公車, three segments — <i>disputed, see below</i>
8xx	Routes opened by the former 臺北縣, Taipei County
9xx	快速公車 running on expressways or motorways

TOKEN	WHAT IT RECORDS ^[6]
0 and its variants	Loops around Taipei Main Station
Colour prefix	捷運接駁公車, metro feeder
Street name	幹線公車, trunk bus
小	Hill minibuses, and the 懷恩專車
新巴士 (F)	New Taipei free community buses
M	市民小巴, community minibus

zh.wikipedia gives an independently worded version of the same axis: 1xx are leisure routes; 2xx began as two-segment fares and 3xx as three; the 5xx, 6xx and 7xx blocks were air-conditioned services; 9xx are express ^[2].

Three separate accounts, and not one of them mentions geography. A geographic reading also circulates in Taiwanese transport writing, in which the leading digit records the part of the city a route was set up to serve — the historic core, then the outward districts, then the routes crossing into what is now New Taipei. No opened authority-backed account supplies those geographic bands. Every account that names an authority instead describes fare segments and service type ^[6] ^[7] ^[2].

6xx and 7xx — the same officer, two answers

BAND	READING A ^[6]	READING B ^[7]
6xx	冷氣公車, two-segment fare ^[6]	後期兩段票路線 — the 2xx block ran out at 299 and 6xx continued it ^[7]
7xx	冷氣公車, three-segment fare ^[6]	由公路客運轉成的聯營公車 — absorbed intercity routes ^[7]

Both outlets attribute to 楊欽文. zh.wikipedia's main text gives Reading A for 7xx and **its own footnote gives Reading B** ^[2]. This page publishes the conflict rather than resolving it: the digits are not settled.

Reading B for 7xx is at least consistent with something the regulator does say — that intercity routes run by the former 臺灣省公路局 were absorbed into joint operation by renumbering from the late 1980s ^[1]. That is a compatibility, not a corroboration.

The numbers that do not exist

There is **no route 8**, and **no route number beginning with 4**. The same PTO Chief Secretary is quoted directly on why ^[7]:

國人的這個風俗習慣，所以避免使用4字頭，8路沒有用的原因，大概考慮是因為在大陸時期，中共的軍隊編號是8路軍，所以那時候就比較忌諱用8路這樣的一個數字。

The four is the ordinary homophone taboo. The eight is not superstition at all: 八路軍, the Eighth Route Army, was a Chinese Communist formation, and a bus route numbered 8 was avoided for that reason^[7]. Note that this bars the *route* numbered 8, not the 8xx band, which the same officer explains as former Taipei County routes^[6].

Suffixes

SUFFIX	MEANS
區 / 區間	A short working over part of the route
副	A branch variant
延	An extension
左 / 右	Anticlockwise / clockwise around a loop

These are in retreat — zh.wikipedia records the directional pair surviving mainly on the Maokong tourist service and one New Taipei route^[2].

小 and 市民小巴

小 prefixes a minibus, typically on hill routes; the same prefix also covers the 懷恩專車 cemetery services^[6]. 市民小巴, rendered **M** in English, is a last-mile community service between neighbourhoods and metro stations.

The six categories

The regulator's own list, which is the closest thing to an official taxonomy: 一般路線 general routes, 幹線公車 trunk buses, 捷運接駁公車 metro feeders, 山區公車 hill routes, 休閒公車 leisure routes, and 市民小巴 community minibuses^[4].

Trunk buses are the interesting category. They were assembled in 2017–18 from existing joint-operation routes running on major arterials, rebranded as 類捷運 — "metro-like" — and named after the streets they run along rather than numbered: 信義幹線, 敦化幹線^[2]. The network is called 八橫八縱, eight horizontal and eight vertical^[2].

Trunk buses, and the colour collision

The trunk network was not conceived on its own. The Public Transport Office's January 2017 release sets out a **four-tier hierarchy** for the whole bus network: 快速 express, 幹線 trunk, 支線 branch, 微循環 micro-circulation^[4].

Phase one was five corridors, named in the release — 「南北向敦化、松江新生2線，東西向之民生、仁愛2線及內湖等共計5線幹線路廊」：Dunhua and Songjiang–Xinsheng running north–south, Minsheng and Renai running east–west, plus Neihu [\[/rail/metro/stations/br19/\]](/rail/metro/stations/br19/)^[4]. The same release gives peak headways of **4–6 minutes** and off-peak **5–10 minutes**, though those figures came back only in an English summary of the page and are carried at lower confidence^[4].

The colour rule, from the regulator

This is the finding. **On a trunk route, colour encodes the compass direction of the corridor**^[3]:

幹線公車依幹線路廊方向賦予其專屬代表色彩，南北向為綠色，東西向為藍色，非屬前述者為黃色

TRUNK COLOUR	CORRIDOR DIRECTION
綠 green	North–south
藍 blue	East–west
黃 yellow	Neither of the above

And the release states what the colours are meant to *mean*, which is the tell that this is a branding scheme rather than a wayfinding code inherited from the metro: 「藍色代表「幹線系統」、「城市」，綠色代表「綠意」、「生活美好」，黃色代表「陽光」、「希望」 — blue for the trunk system and the city, green for greenery and a good life, yellow for sunshine and hope^[3].

So the same colour word means two unrelated things on the same network, and both are current. On a feeder, 綠 means the Songshan–Xindian Line. On a trunk route, 綠 means north–south. 藍 is a metro line on one and a compass bearing on the other. Neither the regulator nor zh.wikipedia notes the clash.

The collision is not hypothetical, because routes have crossed from one side of it to the other^[12]:

WAS	BECAME
棕9 — a Wenhua Line feeder	南京幹線 ^[12]
紅32 — a Tamsui–Xinyi Line feeder	民權幹線 ^[12]
綠1	南環幹線 ^[12]
綠16	東環幹線 ^[12]

WAS	BECAME
220	中山幹線 ^[12]
642	松江新生幹線 ^[12]
650	基隆路幹線 ^[12]
620	北環幹線 ^[12]

棕9 lost a prefix that told you which metro line it served^[2] and gained a name that tells you which street it runs along^[12] — and, under the April 2017 rule, a colour that would now tell you which way it points^[3].

How big is the trunk network

Not settled, and the units do not match.

FIGURE	SOURCE	KIND
16 corridors planned, phased, 5 in phase one	Public Transport Office, January 2017 ^[4]	Primary — but from an English summary of the page
16 routes as at 2 April 2018	中國時報, 1 April 2018, 吳堂靖 — <i>not located by this site and not cited here</i>	Secondary, unverified
19 routes , 「屆時將有19條幹線公車」, after the 1 July 2024 renamings	zh.wikipedia ^[12]	Secondary

Corridors and routes are not the same unit, and 八橫八縱 is sixteen of something. A Public Transport Office release announcing 八橫八縱三環 and nineteen routes surfaced as a search result title, but the page returns HTTP 404; nothing found in this site's searches puts the nineteen-route figure in the regulator's own words. It remains zh.wikipedia's, and secondary.

Sources

Scale, categories, the founding history and the regulator's own account of the system come from the **Taipei Public Transport Office**, and this page cites them throughout^[1]. The trunk-bus colour rule and the four-tier network hierarchy come from two PTO press releases^[3] ^[4]. The money mechanisms come from four **Taipei city regulations**, read in full from the city law database — with the warning that the evaluation-committee rule among them is marked repealed.

The numbering conventions come from two Taiwanese news reports, both attributing to the same named PTO official, and from zh.wikipedia. All three are secondary and are marked so. Where they disagree — and on 6xx and 7xx they disagree while citing the same person — this page publishes every reading rather than choosing.

References

12 of 17 sources on this page are primary — published by the operator, the builder or government.

- 1 **City bus services — an introduction** [https://pto.gov.taipei/News_Content.aspx?n=AAEEE8A01971ECFB&s=FBAD7AB84D95E137]
市區公車—公車簡介

PRIMARY Taipei City Government, Public Transport Office (公共運輸處) accessed 2026-08-10

The regulator's own summary: 「臺北市聯營公車路線數約280餘條，共由14家業者提供運輸服務，車輛數約3,500輛」, the 1976 preparatory committee, the pre-1977 history, and the six service categories 「一般路線、幹線公車、捷運接駁公車、山區公車、休閒公車及市民小巴」. Read in full in Chinese on 10 August 2026: it contains no sentence about revenue pooling and none about route numbering. Both absences were checked against the full Chinese text, not a summary.

- 2 **Taipei city buses** [<https://zh.wikipedia.org/zh-tw/臺北市市區公車>]
臺北市市區公車

SECONDARY 維基百科 (Chinese Wikipedia) accessed 2026-08-10

The fullest account of the numbering conventions anywhere, and the source for the five feeder-bus colour prefixes and for the Airport MRT having none. Its explanation of the numeric bands is fare-segment-based. It is also where the central-revenue-pool sentence circulates: a targeted fetch on 10 August 2026 confirmed that sentence carries no footnote. And it contradicts itself on 7xx between its main text and its own footnote — see the numbering conflict below.

- 3 **Promoting the Taipei trunk-bus identity design programme** [https://pto.gov.taipei/News_Content.aspx?n=D065CCB1467288C8&sms=72544237BBE4C5F6&s=57ADA5C84D54162C]
推動臺北市幹線公車識別設計計畫

PRIMARY Taipei City Government, Public Transport Office (臺北市公共運輸處) accessed 2026-08-10

Released 106-04-20 (20 April 2017). The regulator publishing its own design programme, and the source that settles the trunk-colour question: 「幹線公車依幹線路廊方向賦予其專屬代表色彩，南北向為綠色，東西向為藍色，非屬前述者為黃色」. The quoted sentence was returned verbatim on a second fetch that asked for untranslated Chinese. It also gives the colours' stated symbolism, which is what marks this as branding rather than a wayfinding code inherited from the metro.

- 4 **Opening up the bus network — Taipei trunk buses** [https://www.pto.gov.taipei/News_Content.aspx?n=D065CCB1467288C8&sms=72544237BBE4C5F6&s=6D3EE31152FDB8D2]
打通公車路網—臺北市幹線公車

PRIMARY Taipei City Government, Public Transport Office (臺北市公共運輸處) accessed 2026-08-10

Released 106-01-12 (12 January 2017). Source for the four-tier hierarchy and the five phase-1 corridors, both returned verbatim. The sixteen-corridor plan and the headway figures came back only in an English summary of the page rather than in Chinese, so they are carried here at lower confidence and are flagged as such in the text.

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- 5 **About the joint management committee** [https://www.busgroup.org.tw/about_busgroup]
臺北市公車聯營管理委員會－關於聯管

PRIMARY 臺北市公共汽車客運商業同業公會 / 臺北市公車聯營管理委員會 accessed 2026-08-10

The joint-operation body publishing about itself, fetched in full in Chinese. Source for what the committee is, what it says it does, the four-phase 1977 rollout and the ten founding participants. Its list of its own functions — stop signs, public relations, liaison, review of electronic-ticketing business — does not include running a revenue pool.

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- 6 **Where do the Taipei and New Taipei bus numbers come from? The cryptography hidden in the codes** [<https://www.setn.com/News.aspx?NewsID=563971>]

雙北公車數字怎麼來？編碼藏「密碼學」 公式曝光

SECONDARY 三立新聞網 (SETN) accessed 2026-08-10

A news report about what the regulator says, not the regulator: the numbering table is attributed in the fetched text to 北市公運處主秘楊欽文 (Yang Chin-wen, PTO Chief Secretary). It is the first material this project has found that puts the numbering rule in the regulator's own mouth, and it describes fare segments and service type throughout. It does not mention geography at any point.

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- 7 **There is real learning in bus route codes — no route 8, nothing starting with 4** [<http://news.tvbs.com.tw/life/711846>]

公車路線編碼大有學問！無「8路、4開頭」

SECONDARY TVBS 新聞網 accessed 2026-08-10

Attributes to the same PTO officer as the SETN report, and carries a direct quotation from him on the missing numbers. It disagrees with SETN about 6xx and 7xx while attributing to the same person, which is why this page publishes both readings instead of choosing.

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- 8 **Principles for handling applications to allocate and adjust joint-operation bus routes and departures** [<https://laws.gov.taipei/Law/LawSearch/LawArticleContent/FL055169>]

臺北市聯營公車申請分配調整路線及車次處理原則

PRIMARY 臺北市公共運輸處 (法規類號 北市 07 — 04 — 3006) accessed 2026-08-10

Amended 民國102年03月04日 (4 March 2013), read in full from the Taipei city law database. Source for the route-points mechanism, for open tender through the 臺北都會區市區及公路客運路線審議委員會, and for the city's power to take a high-revenue route back off an operator and re-let it. Also defines 里程 as single-direction kilometres and 車次 as a round trip, both of which the loss-subsidy formula depends on.

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- 9 **Operating rules for reviewing operating-loss subsidies on joint-operation bus service routes** [<https://laws.gov.taipei/law/LawSearch/LawArticleContent/FL026380>]

臺北市聯營公車服務路線營運虧損補貼審議作業規定

PRIMARY 臺北市政府交通局 (法規類號 北市 07 — 04 — 3017) accessed 2026-08-10

Issued 民國102年3月25日, 文號 102北市交運字第10210926400號, read in full. Made under a central regulation rather than a city one: 「特依交通部令頒大眾運輸事業補貼辦法訂定本作業規定」. Carries the subsidy formula, the eligibility test, the central/city cost split, the three priority tiers including 捷運接

駁, and the NT\$10 million threshold that puts a route out to open recruitment. This is the regulation that computes subsidy against per-route, per-operator revenue.

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- 10 Points for implementing fare-difference subsidies on joint-operation buses [<https://laws.gov.taipei/Law/LawSearch/LawArticleContent/FL021697>]

臺北市聯營公車票價差額補貼作業執行要點

PRIMARY 臺北市政府交通局 accessed 2026-08-10

Issued 民國103年4月7日 (北市交運字第10330749201號令), effective 103年5月1日, made under 發展大眾運輸條例 第九條. Fetched in full, though the fetch returned short quoted fragments inside an English scaffold rather than continuous Chinese, so it is carried at slightly lower confidence than the other three regulations. Source for the monthly per-operator reimbursement cycle and for the audit against card issuers' records.

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- 11 Points establishing the supervision and evaluation committee for joint-operation bus operations and service quality [<https://laws.gov.taipei/Law/LawSearch/LawArticleContent/FL012279>]

臺北市聯營公車營運與服務品質督導及評鑑委員會設置要點

PRIMARY 臺北市政府交通局 accessed 2026-08-10

IMPORTANT CAVEAT: the version read is marked 廢 (repealed). It is cited here for the structure it describes — a seventeen-member committee convened by the 交通局局长 with a seat for the operators' own body — and not as the rule currently in force. A successor exists and has not been read. Anything here may have changed.

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- 12 Taipei trunk buses [<https://zh.wikipedia.org/zh-tw/臺北市幹線公車>]

臺北市幹線公車

SECONDARY 維基百科 (Chinese Wikipedia) accessed 2026-08-10

Source for the nineteen-route figure, for 八橫八縱 as the network's nickname, and for the list of numbered and colour-prefixed routes converted into trunk routes. Its own statement of the colour rule 「其中南北向為綠色，東西向為藍色，非屬前兩者為黃色」 agrees with the PTO release, which is corroboration rather than a second source: the encyclopedia is downstream of the regulator here.

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- 13 Greater Taipei Bus — per-route stop list and fare information (信義幹線, 260, 0東) [<https://ebus.gov.taipei/>]

大臺北公車

PRIMARY Taipei and New Taipei City Governments, jointly (臺北市政府、新北市政府) accessed 2026-08-28

The real-time bus system's own per-route pages, which is where 段次 (fare-stage) boundaries are actually published — as a named pair of stops, not a citywide map. Three routes read directly: 信義幹線 (routeid 0161001200, single fare stage), 260 (routeid 0100026020, two-stage, boundary 「岩山里—劍潭」), 0東 (routeid 0100000A00, two-stage, direction-asymmetric boundary).

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- 14 Principles for handling applications to allocate and adjust joint-operation bus routes and departures (vehicle-count clauses) [<https://laws.gov.taipei/Law/LawSearch/LawArticleContent/FL055169>]

臺北市聯營公車申請分配調整路線及車次處理原則 第四條第二項

PRIMARY 臺北市公共運輸處 (法規類號 北市 07 — 04 — 3006) accessed 2026-08-28

Same regulation as law-route-allocation above, re-fetched for its vehicle-count language. 第4條第2項第2款: a route's incoming operator may not propose more vehicles than the route previously had. 第4條第2項第4款: a designated 服務性路線 is capped at 20% of the operator's own highest-revenue route's vehicle count.

15 **Directions for the operating and service evaluation of Taipei City urban bus operators** [<https://laws.gov.taipei/Law/LawSearch/LawArticleContent/FL055087>]

臺北市市區汽車客運業營運與服務評鑑執行要點

PRIMARY Taipei City Government (臺北市政府法規查詢系統) accessed 2026-08-28

Read specifically to test whether evaluation scores a route or an operator. 第2條: 「路線積分，係指交通局依各期評鑑成績及評鑑項目成績所給予之評分」 — route points are derived from the operator's own periodic score. 第7條第4項: 路線積分之有效期限為二年. No route-level scoring methodology is stated anywhere in the regulation.

16 **Fare information** [<https://www.busgroup.org.tw/fare>]

票價資訊

PRIMARY 臺北市公車聯營管理委員會 accessed 2026-08-28

The joint committee's own general statement of the fare-stage crossing rule: 「臺北市聯營公車係依路段分段收費，搭乘二段票(含)以上路線之車輛，若跨越分段點(或分段緩衝區)，應加收一段票」.

17 **Taipei city bus tokens** [<https://zh.wikipedia.org/zh-tw/台北市公共汽車乘車專用幣>]

台北市公共汽車乘車專用幣

SECONDARY 維基百科 (Chinese Wikipedia) accessed 2026-08-10

Cited for one sentence only — the 四分法 fixed-formula revenue split in the early years of joint operation — and cited with its own footnote showing, because the footnote is the point. It resolves to 唯真，〈關心話題 正本清源談公車票證〉，聯合報，1981-04-13, which this project has not read: the 聯合報 archive is not openly fetchable. This is a lead toward the revenue question, not an answer to it.

Last updated: 2026-08-10

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Station names, codes and sequence from TDX Transport Data eXchange, Ministry of Transportation and Communications, operators TRTC, NTMC, TYMC, and TMRT. Government open data. Retrieved 2026-08-24; source last updated 2016-11-23. The 12 Sanying station records absent from TDX are sourced directly to New Taipei Metro and government publications on their pages. Provenance.